JACOB R. SMITH

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Middle Tennessee State University (expected May 2027)

Dissertation: *Three Essays on Regulation, Private Order, and the Public Interest* (chair: Daniel J. Smith; committee: Adam Rennhoff and Nicholas A. Jensen); defense expected spring 2027

M.A. Economics, Middle Tennessee State University (2025)

B.S. Mathematical Economics (second major in Philosophy), *magna cum laude*, Hampden-Sydney College (2023)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of record, Middle Tennessee State University

Principles of Microeconomics, Fall 2026 (in progress)

Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2026

Instructor Evaluation Mean: 4.02/5 (average of the ten rated items)

Principles of Microeconomics, Fall 2025

Instructor Evaluation Mean: 4.45/5 (average of the ten rated items)

TEACHING INTERESTS

Intermediate Microeconomics; Mathematical Economics; Environmental and Natural Resource Economics; Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics; Law and Economics; Public Economics and Public Choice; Political Economy of Regulation; American Economic History; History of Economic Thought; Money and Banking; Introductory Econometrics. With adequate preparation time, prepared to teach any undergraduate course in the curriculum.

SOFTWARE

Stata, R, LaTeX; Python (working knowledge)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics; Political Economy of Regulation; Public Choice; Historical Political Economy; Austrian Economics

WORKING PAPERS

“Distillers and Chemists: Capture by Eligibility in the Bottled-in-Bond Act of 1897” (job market paper)

“Private Mechanisms for Stopping Diamond-Dybvig Runs: Evidence from U.S. Newspapers, 1889–1929” (with Daniel J. Smith)

"Who Killed the Green Fairy? Temperance, Language, and Wine in the Swiss Absinthe Ban of 1908" (with Nicholas A. Jensen)

"Uncorked: How Wall Street Priced the Repeal of Prohibition" (with Patricia Hummel and Corey Pendleton)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Crisis and Local Leviathan"

OTHER WRITING

"When 'Consumer Protection' Protects Producers from Competition," *The Daily Economy* (AIER), August 11, 2026

ACADEMIC CONFERENCE PAPER PRESENTATIONS

"Bottled in Bondage," *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Fort Lauderdale, Florida, November 19–21, 2022

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic Use of the Bottled-in-Bond Act of 1897 by Both Firms and Regulators," *Public Choice Society Meetings*. Plano, Texas, March 14–16, 2024

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic Use of the Bottled-in-Bond Act of 1897 by Both Firms and Regulators," *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Washington, DC, November 23–25, 2024

"The Father of Food and Drug Law as Strategic Regulator: Dr. Harvey Wiley and the Political Economy of the Bottled-in-Bond Act," *Public Choice Society Meetings*. Louisville, Kentucky, March 6–8, 2025

"Panic Before Protection: Bank Runs, Contagion, and Mitigation Measures in the United States, 1889–1919," *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Tampa, Florida, November 22–24, 2025

"When Life Gives You Lemons: Bootleggers, Baptists, and the Political Market for Adverse Selection," *Markets & Society 2026*. Falls Church, Virginia, October 23–26, 2026

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic Capture of the Bottled-in-Bond Act of 1897," *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting* (SDAE Graduate Student Essay Contest winners session). Houston, Texas, November 21–23, 2026 (scheduled)

"Who Killed the Green Fairy? Temperance, Language, and Wine in the Swiss Absinthe Ban of 1908," *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Houston, Texas, November 21–23, 2026 (scheduled)

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Winner, Graduate Student Essay Contest, Society for the Development of Austrian Economics (2026)

American Institute for Economic Research Graduate Fellowship (Summer 2026)

Beta Gamma Sigma, International Business Honor Society (2026)

Political Economy Research Institute Ph.D. Summer Fellowship, $5,000 (2024, 2025, 2026)

Economic Freedom Research Colloquium Honorarium, Bridwell Institute, $3,000 (2025)

Pi Mu Epsilon, National Honorary Mathematics Society (2022)

Center for the Study of Political Economy Fellowship (2019–2023)

COLLOQUIA AND WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

Public Choice Outreach Conference, Center for Study of Public Choice, GMU (2023)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Public Choice, AIER (2024)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Defending Classical Liberalism, AIER (2025)

Summer Seminars on Classical Liberalism, AIER, UIC, UIS, and Wabash College (2025)

Economic Freedom Research Colloquium, Bridwell Institute, SMU Cox (2025)

Law & Economics with Public Choice Insights Workshop, Stephenson Institute for Classical Liberalism (2025)

The Untold Stories Behind Financial Crises Workshop, INET-YSI-University of Lyon 2 (2025)

"Giving an Effective Job Talk" Graduate Papers Workshop, Institute for Humane Studies (2026)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Governance and Self-Governance: Vincent Ostrom's Framework, AIER (2026)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Session chair and discussant, Public Choice Society Meetings, Louisville (2025)

Referee, *Virginia Economic Journal* (2026)

Moderator, panel on Tennessee whiskey regulation, MTSU Special Collections (scheduled April 2027)

EXPERIENCE

Defense Logistics Agency – Aviation, Richmond, VA May 2021 – Present (intermittent)

Post-Award Contract Specialist (Trainee)

- Federal contract administration under the FAR/DFARS; resolved contract discrepancies with OEM vendors and subject-matter experts

REFERENCES

Daniel J. Smith (advisor) — Professor of Economics and Director, Political Economy Research Institute, Middle Tennessee State University · daniel.smith@mtsu.edu

Adam Rennhoff — Professor of Economics and Director of Graduate Programs in Economics, Middle Tennessee State University · adam.rennhoff@mtsu.edu

Ryan M. Yonk — Director of Education and Senior Research Fellow, American Institute for Economic Research · ryan.yonk@aier.org